

AETHERIA INFRASTRUCTURE RESEARCH (AIR)

Organisation Profile

AIR-ISMS-ORG-001 | Version 1.0 | May 2026

Document Control

Document ID	AIR-ISMS-ORG-001
Version	1.0
Status	Approved
Classification	Confidential
Document Owner	Head of Security & Compliance
Approved By	Chief Executive Officer
Approval Date	May 2026
Review Cycle	Annual / following significant organisational change
Next Review Due	May 2027

1. Purpose of This Document

This document establishes the organisational context for AIR's Information Security Management System (ISMS). It records the internal and external factors that shape AIR's approach to information security, identifies the stakeholders whose needs the ISMS must address, and provides the foundation for all ISMS policies, risk assessments, and controls.

This document directly addresses ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Clause 4, which requires organisations to understand their context before determining the scope and design of their ISMS. It is the starting point of the ISMS document hierarchy and should be read before any other ISMS document.

2. Organisation Overview

2.1 Identity and Mission

Aetheria Infrastructure Research (AIR) is a European research organisation specialising in the analysis, modelling, and resilience assessment of critical infrastructure systems. Founded in 2018 and headquartered in Madrid, Spain, AIR's work is related to infrastructure engineering, geospatial data science, and applied artificial intelligence.

AIR's mission is to provide governments, regulators, and infrastructure operators with the analytical insight they need to understand, protect, and strengthen the systems that support modern society, from energy networks and transport to water systems and digital communications infrastructure.

AIR conducts independent applied research funded by public-sector grants and government partnerships and develops proprietary AI-powered analytical tools that it licenses to infrastructure operators and national authorities. This dual model creates a complex information environment in which government-classified research data, sensitive AI models, and third-party partner data must be managed simultaneously.

2.2 Legal and Corporate Structure

Attribute	Detail
Legal Name	Aetheria Infrastructure Research S.L.
Legal Form	Sociedad Limitada, incorporated in Spain
Registered Address	Calle de Alcalá 189, 28009 Madrid, Spain
Company Registration	CIF: B-82547118 Registered with the Registro Mercantil de Madrid
Founded	2018
Ownership	Privately held. Majority owned by founding partners.
Revenue Model	Government research contracts (~55%) AI platform licensing (~30%) Consultancy and advisory (~15%)
Regulatory Jurisdiction	Spain (primary) EU regulatory frameworks apply across all operations
EU VAT Number	ESB82547118

2.3 Locations

Office	Role	Address	Headcount
Madrid HQ	Primary headquarters. Executive leadership, research operations, IT infrastructure, data repositories.	Calle de Alcalá 189, 28009 Madrid, Spain	98 staff
Brussels	EU policy and partnerships office. Government relations, legal, regulatory affairs.	Avenue Louise 54, 1050 Brussels, Belgium	27 staff
Riga	AI Engineering hub.	Skolas iela 45, 29249 Riga, Latvia	20 staff

All three offices operate under a unified IT environment managed from Madrid HQ. Remote working is supported across all locations. Field research activities occur at infrastructure sites across Europe, typically involving staff from Madrid and Riga.

2.4 Workforce

Category	Count	Access Profile	Typical Data Access
Permanent Employees	120	Full Entra ID accounts. Managed endpoints. Standard and elevated roles per department.	Internal to Restricted, depending on role
Contractors and Research Collaborators	25	Entra ID guest or member accounts dependant to engagement. Managed or compliant device required for Restricted access.	Internal to Restricted, depending on project
External Partners (no system access)	Variable	No AIR system access. Data shared via approved secure transfer channels only.	Receives AIR outputs only, no access to source data
Total Headcount	145		

3. Products and Services

3.1 Research and Analysis

AIR's core research activity focuses on the vulnerability of critical infrastructure networks. Research outputs include classified analysis reports, geospatial risk models, and scenario assessments delivered to government clients. Current active research programmes include:

- National energy grid vulnerability assessment, commissioned by a Latvian federal agency
- Cross-border transport corridor resilience modelling, EU Horizon-funded consortium
- Urban water network failure cascade analysis, partnership with a Spanish national authority
- Satellite communications infrastructure risk taxonomy, NATO advisory programme

Research data produced under these programmes is classified Restricted or Confidential under AIR's information classification standard and is subject to specific data handling obligations defined in individual agreements.

3.2 AI Platform and Tools

AIR develops and operates AI-powered analytical tools under the internal product name ARIA (Aetheria Resilience Intelligence Architecture). ARIA components include:

- isMap: a geospatial AI model for infrastructure interdependency mapping and failure propagation simulation
- RealRisk: a machine learning model for dynamic risk scoring of infrastructure assets based on real-time sensor and open-source data
- CascadeML: a graph neural network model for cascade failure prediction across interconnected infrastructure networks

ARIA model weights, training datasets, and inference infrastructure are classified Restricted. Model deployment occurs only within AIR's Azure environment (air-prod tenant). Licensing agreements with external operators provide API access to inference endpoints only. No model weights or training data are shared externally.

3.3 Advisory and Consultancy

AIR provides expert advisory services to governments, regulators, and infrastructure operators. These advisory outputs are typically Confidential and governed by individual contracts. Advisory work frequently involves access to operational data, which is handled under data processing agreements aligned with GDPR.

4. Technology Landscape

AIR operates a cloud-first technology environment centred on Microsoft Azure and the Microsoft 365 productivity suite. The following systems form the primary technology landscape within the ISMS scope.

System / Platform	Purpose	Classification of Data Processed	Asset IDs
Microsoft Azure (air-prod tenant)	Cloud infrastructure, storage for research data, virtual networks, and identity services.	Restricted — Confidential	SA-001, SA-002, SA-003
Microsoft Entra ID	Identity and access management. Single sign-on, MFA, Conditional Access, Privileged Identity Management.	Confidential (identity data)	SA-004

Microsoft 365	Email, Teams, SharePoint, OneDrive. Primary collaboration and communication platform.	Internal — Confidential	SA-005, SA-006
GitHub Enterprise (org: airtech)	Source code hosting for ARIA models, internal tools.	Restricted — Confidential	SA-007
On-Premises Research Repositories (Madrid HQ)	Legacy research datasets and field data not yet migrated to Azure. Physical access restricted to IT Operations.	Restricted	SA-008
Microsoft Intune	Mobile device management for 145 managed Windows endpoints. Enforces BitLocker, screen lock, update, and compliance policies.	Internal (device telemetry)	SA-009
Jira and Confluence	Project management and internal knowledge base. Hosted on Atlassian Cloud.	Internal — Confidential	SA-010, SA-011
Azure Key Vault	Secrets management, API keys, and certificates.	Restricted (credential data)	SA-012

Personal devices are not within the ISMS scope and are not permitted to access Restricted or Confidential systems unless accessing AIR's Azure Virtual Desktop environment.

5. Departments and Organisational Structure

AIR is organised into six departments, each headed by a Director or Head who reports to the Chief Executive Officer.

Department	Head	Primary Location	Core Function	Headcount
Executive Leadership	Chief Executive Officer	Madrid	Strategic direction, government relations, investor reporting.	4
Infrastructure Analytics	Head of Infrastructure Analytics	Madrid	Delivery of government research programmes.	42
AI Engineering	Head of AI Engineering	Riga	Design, training, and deployment of ARIA AI models.	28
IT Operations	Head of IT Operations	Madrid	Infrastructure management, endpoint fleet, cloud operations, helpdesk, security tooling.	18
Legal & Partnerships	Head of Legal & Partnerships	Brussels	Contract management, GDPR compliance, government partnership agreements, procurement, supplier management.	14
Security & Compliance	Head of Security & Compliance	Madrid	ISMS ownership, risk management, internal audit, policy development, security awareness, incident coordination.	6
Programme Management	Programme Director	Madrid / Brussels	Programme coordination, reporting to funders and government partners.	8

6. Interested Parties and Their Requirements

ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Clause 4.2 requires AIR to identify the parties that are relevant to its ISMS and to understand their information security requirements. The following parties have been identified, along with the specific requirements they place on AIR's information security posture.

Interested Party	Relationship	Information Security Requirements
Government Research Partners (e.g. Latvian federal agency, national authorities)	Primary research clients and data providers.	Strict data classification and handling requirements. Contractual breach notification obligations (typically 24 hours). Right to audit AIR's data handling practices.
European Commission / EU Funding Bodies	Horizon and other EU research grant funders.	Open data requirements for non-sensitive research outputs. GDPR compliance.
Infrastructure Operators (AI platform licensees)	Commercial licensees of ARIA inference APIs.	Data processing agreements. Service availability and confidentiality.
Employees and Contractors	Internal workforce delivering AIR's mission.	Right to have personal data (HR records) handled lawfully under GDPR. Clear security obligations communicated and consistently enforced.
Regulatory Authorities	AEPD (Spain), IPgP (Latvia), relevant national data protection and cybersecurity authorities.	GDPR compliance. NIS2 Directive obligations (as a provider of services to essential entities).
Certification Body	External auditor for ISO/IEC 27001:2022 certification.	Demonstrable implementation of all applicable Annex A controls. Maintained ISMS documentation.
Suppliers and Sub-processors	Technology vendors, cloud providers, contractors.	Contractual security obligations. GDPR Article 28 processor agreements. Incident notification to AIR within 24 hours of discovery.
Investors and Board	Minority institutional investor and founding partner shareholders.	Assurance that information security risk is managed proportionately.

7. Internal Context

ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Clause 4.1 requires AIR to understand the internal issues that are relevant to its purpose and that could affect its ability to achieve the intended outcomes of its ISMS.

7.1 Governance and Culture

- AIR has a management structure with six departments reporting directly to the CEO. Decision-making is centralised, which enables fast policy adoption but creates dependency on key individuals, particularly the Head of Security & Compliance.
- The organisation is research-led. Researchers and engineers prioritise delivery speed, which can create tension with security controls that add friction to workflows. Security awareness and culture are at an early stage.
- Management commitment to information security is genuine and documented. The CEO has approved and signed the Information Security Policy and the ISMS investment has been formally budgeted.

7.2 Strategic Objectives Relevant to the ISMS

The following strategic objectives directly influence the design and priorities of AIR's ISMS:

Strategic Objective	ISMS Implication
Grow government research contract revenue by 40% by 2028.	New government partnerships will bring additional data handling obligations and audit rights. ISMS maturity is increasingly a prerequisite for contracts.
Achieve ISO/IEC 27001:2022 certification by Q1 2027.	The ISMS must reach a certifiable standard within the roadmap timeframe.
Expand ARIA platform to three new EU member state infrastructure operators by 2027.	Expansion increases the volume of third-party data processed and the number of data processing agreements AIR must maintain.
Establish Riga as a Centre of Excellence for AI safety research.	AI Engineering growth increases the sensitivity of the data held in GitHub Enterprise and Azure ML environments.
Reduce operational risk to government partnerships following the 2025 near-miss incident.	A near-miss event involving a contractor account in late 2025 was the immediate reason for formalising the ISMS. Risk reduction in access control and offboarding is a top priority.

8. External Context

External issues that are relevant to AIR's purpose and that could affect its ISMS are identified across four domains: regulatory, threat, sector, and geopolitical.

8.1 Regulatory Environment

Regulation / Framework	Applicability to AIR	Key Obligations
GDPR (EU 2016/679)	Applies to all processing of personal data by AIR, including employee records, contractor data, and personal data collected during research.	Lawful basis for processing. Data subject rights. 72-hour breach notification to supervisory authority. Data Protection Impact Assessments. Record of Processing Activities.
NIS2 Directive (EU 2022/2555)	AIR provides analytical services and AI tools to operators of essential entities (energy, transport). As a managed service provider to these entities, AIR may fall within NIS2 scope as a significant entity.	Incident notification obligations. Supply chain security requirements. Risk management measures aligned to NIS2. Potential registration with national competent authority.
EU AI Act (2024/1689)	ARIA models used for infrastructure risk assessment may be classified as high-risk AI systems under Annex III (critical infrastructure management).	Conformity assessment requirements. Transparency and explainability obligations. Risk management system for AI systems. Human oversight requirements.
Spanish National Security Scheme (ENS — Real Decreto 311/2022)	Applies if AIR processes data or provides services to Spanish public administration entities under research contracts.	Security requirements based on data classification. Mandatory security controls aligned to ENS categories.
ISO/IEC 27001:2022	Voluntary certification target, required by several government partners as a condition of contract.	Full ISMS implementation. All 93 Annex A controls assessed in SoA. Continuous improvement and annual surveillance audits post-certification.

8.2 Threat Landscape

AIR's threat environment is elevated compared to a typical commercial organisation, due to the sensitivity of its research subject matter and the nature of its government partnerships.

Threat Category	Relevance to AIR	Risk Register Reference
Nation-State Espionage	AIR's critical infrastructure analysis outputs are of direct interest to foreign intelligence services. Attacks targeting government research partnerships are documented across the European research sector.	RSK-003, RSK-004, RSK-007
Ransomware	Research organisations with government ties are targeted by ransomware groups for both financial extortion and reputational damage to public-sector partners.	RSK-009
Supply Chain Compromise	AI models and research software dependencies represent a potential supply chain attack vector. Contractor accounts are documented in the sector.	RSK-001, RSK-008
Insider Threat	Research organisations face elevated insider risk from departing staff and contractors with access to IP. The 2025 near-miss incident involved a contractor account.	RSK-005, RSK-007
Phishing and Credential Theft	Targeted spear-phishing against research and public-sector staff is pervasive. Credential compromise is the most common initial access point across the sector.	RSK-002

9. Key Dependencies and Constraints

The following dependencies and constraints have implications for the design and operation of AIR's ISMS and are recorded here.

Dependency / Constraint	Nature	ISMS Implication
Microsoft Azure and M365	Technical dependency	Most of AIR's security controls depend on Microsoft security tooling. A Microsoft platform outage or misconfiguration could affect multiple controls simultaneously.
Belgian federal agency data sharing agreement	Contractual constraint	The most restrictive data handling obligations in AIR's portfolio.
GDPR / AEPD jurisdiction	Regulatory constraint	As a Spanish-registered company, AIR's lead supervisory authority is the AEPD. All GDPR notifications go to AEPD first, even for incidents affecting non-Spanish data subjects.
Small Security & Compliance team	Resource constraint	The 6-person Security & Compliance team cannot maintain the ISMS, run awareness programmes, manage incidents, and build new capabilities simultaneously without prioritisation trade-offs.
Research delivery timelines	Operational constraint	Government research deliverables create fixed deadlines that cannot be moved. Security controls that impede research delivery will face internal resistance and require executive-level escalation to enforce.
Contractor model	Workforce constraint	25 contractors with rotating engagement dates create a continuous offboarding challenge. Until automated deprovisioning is in place, manual processes introduce persistent risk.

11. Approval

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Document Owner	Head of Security & Compliance		May 2026
Executive Approver	Chief Executive Officer		May 2026